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Conditional statements 7m

If you want to write code that performs different actions for different decisions, you will need to use conditional statements.

For example, if you want to display a 'Good morning' greeting but only want it to be displayed in the morning, then you could use a conditional statement that only displays 'Good morning' if the time is before 12 noon.

For example, if you want to display a 'Good morning' greeting but only want it to be displayed in the morning, then you could use a conditional statement that only displays 'Good morning' if the time is less than 12.00 pm.

```
if (hour < 12) {  
  
  greeting = "Good morning";  
  
}
```

Here is another example on MDN Web Docs.



There are four conditional statements in JavaScript.

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Conditional statement	Description	Syntax	Example
if	'if' is used to specify when a block of code is to be used when a specified condition is true.	<pre> if (condition) { // block of code to be executed if the condition is true } </pre>	<pre> if (hour < 12) { greeting = 'Good morning'; } Result: 'Good morning' greeting is created if the time is before 12 noon. </pre>
else	'else' is used to specify when a block of code is to be used when a specified condition is false.	<pre> if (condition) { // block of code to be executed if the condition is true } else { // block of code to be executed if the condition is false } </pre>	<pre> if (hour < 12) { greeting = 'Good morning'; } else { greeting = 'Good afternoon'; } Result: If the time is before 12 noon, 'Good morning' greeting is created; otherwise, 'Good afternoon' greeting is created. </pre>

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else if	'else if' is used to specify another condition to be used if the first condition is false, but this new condition, specified under the 'else if' statement, is true.	<pre> if (condition1) { // block of code to be executed if condition1 is true } else if (condition2) { // block of code to be executed if the condition1 is false and condition2 is true } else { // block of code to be executed if the condition1 is false and condition2 is false } </pre>	<pre> if (time < 12) { greeting = 'Good morning'; } else if (time < 18) { greeting = 'Good afternoon'; } else { greeting = 'Good evening'; } </pre> Result: If the time is before 12 noon, the greeting 'Good morning' will be created. If not, but the time is before 6 pm, a 'Good afternoon' greeting will be created; otherwise, a 'Good evening' greeting will be created.
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switch	A 'switch' statement is used to specify alternative actions that are to be performed based on different conditions.	<pre> Switch (expression) { case x: // code block break; case y: // code block break; default: // code block } </pre>	<pre> dt = new Date() dy = dt .getDay() switch (dy) { case 6: text = 'Today is Saturday'; break; case 0: text = 'Today is Sunday'; break; default: text = 'Looking forward to the weekend'; } Result: If the day is a Saturday, then 'Today is Saturday' will appear. </pre>
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If the day is a Sunday,
then 'Today is Sunday'
will appear.

If the day is not
Saturday (6) or Sunday
(0) then 'Looking
forward to the
weekend' will appear.



Dig deeper

To explore conditional statements more, read these resources:

- *JavaScript If, Else, and Else If* (W3Schools, n.d.)
- *JavaScript Switch Statement* (W3Schools, n.d.).



Thoughts on this page?

